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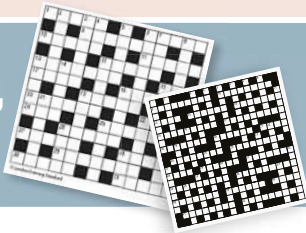
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sectarian play
fails in Syria**



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**WHY YOUR COMFORT
FOOD MAY TRIGGER
MORE STRESS**



AFP

■ **From left:** Israeli journalist and filmmaker Yuval Abraham, US producer Rachel Szor, filmmaker Hamdan Ballal and Palestinian journalist and filmmaker Basel Adra pose with their Oscar statuettes in the press room at the Dolby Theatre in Hollywood, California, on Sunday.

Palestinian-Israeli film wins big

'No Other Land'
wins Oscar for Best
Documentary

DUBAI

BY MANJUSHA
RADHAKRISHNAN
Entertainment Editor

N*No Other Land*, a Palestinian-Israeli documentary film highlighting efforts to prevent community demolitions in the West Bank, won the Oscar for Best Documentary on Sunday. This win is the first for Palestine.

The film, a collaboration between Israeli and Palestinian filmmakers, follows activist Basel Adra as he documents the destruction of his hometown, which has been designated for military training. His efforts to raise awareness gain traction

**We made this film
as Palestinians and
Israelis because,
together, our voices
are stronger."**

Yuval Abraham
Israeli journalist

when he partners with Israeli journalist Yuval Abraham, who helps amplify his story.

"We made this film as Palestinians and Israelis because, together, our voices are stronger," said Abraham in his acceptance speech.

Filmed between 2019 and 2023, the documentary captures the struggles of residents in Masafer Yatta, a region facing frequent demolitions. The film relies on Adra's personal

footage, documenting key moments of resistance and community efforts to rebuild.

In the film, Abraham immerses himself in the community but acknowledges differences in their experiences. While Adra faces restrictions on his movement, Abraham, as an Israeli citizen, has greater freedom. "When I look at Basel, I see my brother, but we are unequal," Abraham said on stage. "We need a future built on equality and national rights for both peoples."

Reflecting on the challenges his community faces, Adra shared a personal moment: "About two months ago, I became a father. My hope for my daughter is that she will not have to live the same life I'm living now — always fearing displacement and violence."

SEE ALSO P16

Major policy changes for Indian passport application

Birth certificates
mandatory for
individuals born on
or after Oct 1, 2023

DUBAI

BY LEKSHMY PAVITHRAN
Assistant Online Editor

In a major policy change, the Indian government has revised the passport application process, mandating birth certificates as the only acceptable proof of date of birth for individuals born on or after October 1, 2023.

According to a notification issued by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on February 24, the amendment to the Passport Rules, 1980, will take effect once published in the official Gazette. This move aims to standardise documentation and ensure uniformity in age verification.

For individuals born before the cut-off date, the government will continue to accept multiple documents as proof of date of birth.

The government has also announced plans to expand Post Office Passport Seva Kendras (POPSKs).

As per recent amend-

**Residential addresses
will no longer be
printed on the last
page of the passport.
Instead, immigration
officials will access
the applicant's
residential data by
scanning a barcode.**

ments, residential addresses will no longer be printed on the last page of the passport. Instead, immigration officials will access the applicant's residential data by scanning a barcode, ensuring enhanced privacy and security.

The government has also introduced a colour-coded passport system:

Red: Diplomatic passport holders

White: Government officials

Blue: All other regular passport holders

To accommodate children of single parents or individuals from estranged families, the parents' names will no longer be printed on the last page of the passport. This amendment is designed to be inclusive and considerate of diverse family structures.

UAE's Ramadan initiatives to aid millions globally

VARIOUS HUMANITARIAN CAMPAIGNS
TO HELP PEOPLE IN OVER 75 NATIONS

ABU DHABI

The UAE has launched a series of cross-continental humanitarian initiatives and campaigns during Ramadan, reaffirming its position as a global capital of generosity and compassion.

One of the key initiatives this year is The Fathers' Endowment campaign, launched by His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai.

This initiative honours fathers in the UAE by establishing a sustainable endowment fund worth Dh1 billion, with its proceeds dedicated to providing medical care and health care support for impoverished individuals globally.

The Emirates Red Crescent (ERC) also announced that its Ramadan programmes will benefit 4.5 million people across 53 countries in Asia, Africa, Europe, and South America, with a total cost of Dh31.9 million. These programmes include Iftar meals, Zakat Al Fitr, Eid clothing, Ramadan food baskets, and emergency food aid, aimed at alleviating humanitarian hardships in various regions.

Meanwhile, the Zayed Bin Sultan Al Nahyan Charitable and Humanitarian Foundation has kicked off its annual Ramadan initiative, Iftar Project, in more

4.5m

people in 53 nations
to benefit from ERC's
Ramadan initiatives

than 13 countries worldwide, benefiting over 465,000 individuals in Jordan, Egypt, Pakistan, Kazakhstan, Bangladesh, Malaysia, Belarus, Kosovo, Indonesia, Ethiopia, the Philippines, Comoros, and Brazil.

The International Charity Organisation has also launched a Ramadan campaign focused on humanitarian and development projects worth Dh156 million.

In Ras Al Khaimah, the Ras Al Khaimah Charity Association's Homes of Goodness, initiative aims to build houses for the needy abroad, with costs starting at Dh21,200 per home.

Similarly, Dar Al Ber Society has rolled out a large-scale Ramadan campaign under the theme With Your Giving, Goodness is Completed, covering the UAE and 21 other countries, benefiting 1.7 million individuals, with 1.4 million of them outside the UAE.

Meanwhile, Sharjah Charity International has announced its Joud 2025 Ramadan campaign, which aims to bring joy to 1.1 million beneficiaries inside and outside the country.

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MIDDLE EAST

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emboldened by
Trump | P10**



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Ramadan overtime
capped at two hours in
most cases **P3**

PRAYER TIMINGS

IFTAR 18:26

Fajr 05:22 Shuruq 06:35
Dhuhr 12:33 Asr 15:53
Maghrib 18:26 Isha 19:39

IMSAK 05:12

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes
for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

SPORT

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